Project Bridge — PRD-lite

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Problem. September card money sits in four records that should agree and do not: processor, Mastercard clearing, the USD bridge account and the ledger. Reconciled by hand at month-end, breaks surface late. This month the Mastercard payable (2105) closes with a **debit** of USD 70,588.66, a liability on the wrong side: one daily processor entry never posted, another posted in October, and the bank paid one settlement twice. No single file shows it.

Users. Finance Ops runs it and works the exceptions; the Controller approves entries and needs every number traced to a source row; Treasury owns settlement, cash and funding.

Success measures (baseline → target)

- Figures traceable to a source file and row: spreadsheets with no row link → 100 % on screen and in exports.
- Processor–Mastercard difference: USD 15,600.17 (net of interchange and scheme fees) to explain by hand → USD 0.00 residual, split into timing, real error and data issue.
- A missing feed day: found on working day 3 (T02 still in progress) → flagged before reconciling, next business day.
- Reconciliations ready: working day 5, the Controller's deadline → working day 1, on the path to daily (target).

Options considered

- *Spreadsheet + AI skill:* fuzzy matching 3,000+ dirty rows is fragile. *Web app:* the reviewer installs a Python stack. *Agent as the main tool:* the reconciliation must be deterministic; an agent belongs on top.
- **Chosen: a standard-library Python script → one self-contained page + CSVs.** Opens with a double click; plain, tested logic; every row keeps its source id.

Built beyond the reconciliation. The Mastercard invoice accrued line by line; a Treasury view with days of coverage and an illustrative weekly transfer; an ERP import file marked not approved; close tasks with the owner role and, where the email thread names one, the person.

Left out. *By design:* posting — people approve and post. *For time (written, not built):* shared notes (today they live in the analyst's browser); live connections to sources, email and Slack; margin by customer and country; two agents for a day-zero close, one answering questions with citations, one proposing rules with their tests for the Controller.

Risks

- *Fuzzy matches can be wrong:* accepted only when unique, and labelled. *Inference dressed as fact:* unprovable causes are marked unconfirmed; their entries wait for evidence.
- *Approval limits:* the policy says "net", but a balanced entry nets to zero; we use total debits. *No preparer or approver in the ledger extract:* posted entries cannot be checked. *Synthetic data:* rebuild the input contracts.